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As a child, I was secure within my family. The challenge for my parents was to create a learning environment that was both safe, and novel and stimulating—and they undoubtedly succeeded at it. Sometimes, a child's ways of exploration can be dangerous. The same could have happened with me. I had seen my parents put metal objects into electric sockets, fiddle with radio parts, use a matchstick to start a fire and push buttons on electronic devices. I was a great mimic, so my curiosity would often send me out to explore. I might have put a fork in the electric socket, I might have taken things apart, I might have ended up harming myself. But my parents ensured that they were always vigilant, supervising my explorations and fostering in me a sense of freedom. Therefore, my curiosity was channelled well and it turned me into a quick learner.

The INSB test was a cakewalk. Although that wasn't the case with many others. Hema was a bit disappointed—she was confused during the test and might have written the answers wrong. But I was relieved that it was over. The officer instructor collected the answer sheets and called out our names, two candidates at a time, sending us in pairs to adjacent rooms, where the instrumental humming of machines had been coming from. I was both curious and nervous at the same time. When I walked through the door into the first room, I saw two machines with joysticks, buttons and screens. *Would I be able to understand it?* But many before me had made sense of it and passed; it shouldn't be a problem, I told myself. There was an instructor sergeant inside who began his briefing, 'Good evening to you both, welcome to the Sensory Motor Apparatus Test. It may sound complex, but it is a simple test . . .'

The test was just like playing a console game, but aimed at measuring the psychomotor coordination skills of the candidate. There were two rectangles on a black screen—a small rectangle inside a bigger one. There was a dot on the screen, which had to be adjusted inside the small rectangle with a joystick. Using one's peripheral vision, one had to press the buttons on an adjacent panel as they lit up. A red and green light on the screen had